

Booting directly from an ISO image present in the hard disk

Grub2 has the capability to boot directly from the ISO file present in your hard drive's storage. This method may also be useful for distro hoppers, who want to save time in creating bootable media and who wish to avoid inserting a USB device into their systems every time, to try live distributions. Just paste your downloaded ISO in any known location inside one of your partitions.

Open the ISO in any archive manager, go inside the *Casper* folder and view its contents.

The file with *vmlinuz.efi* or a similar name is your kernel file and *initrd.gz* (or something similar) is your initial ramdisk whose name you require in the next step.

Open the file in a text editor:

```
vi /etc/grub.d/40_custom
```

Then add the following menu entry at the end:

```
menuentry "New os" {
loopback loop (hd0,2)/home/user/mynewos.iso
linux (loop)/casper/vmlinuz.efi boot=casper iso-scan/
filename=/home/user/mynewos.iso noprompt noeject
initrd (loop)/casper/initrd.gz
}
```

Here, in (hd0,2), '0' represents the internal hard disk (sda) and '2' represents the partition number (sda2). Now save this file and run the following command:

```
$sudo update-grub
```

Reboot and select the new OS entry in the boot menu. If all the files' names and configurations are correct, you will boot into the OS image that was present on your hard disk.

—Shubham Dubey, sdubey504@gmail.com

Setting a commit template for a repository in Git

Git allows us to set a user-defined commit template for a particular repository so that every time anyone performs a commit, the template will be opened and one can fill it. This method is useful to make all commit messages uniform.

Let us create a template called '*.commit-template.txt*' in the current repository with the following contents:

```
$ cat .commit-template.txt
```

```
Short commit message(try to keep under 60 characters)
Multi-line description about this commit
```

Ticket: BUG-123

Now set this file as a template using the following command:

```
$ git config commit.template .commit-template.txt
```

Verify that the template is set properly using the following command:

```
$ git config -l | grep commit.template
commit.template=.commit-template.txt
```

If everything goes fine, it means the template has been set correctly. Now, when anyone does a commit in this repository, the template will be opened in the editor.



Note: This method will not work if you use the *-m* option with the Git commit.

—Narendra K., narendra0002017@gmail.com



Getting the system installation time on Ubuntu

To know how old your installation is, run the following commands:

```
$ls -ld /var/log/installer| cut -d " " -f 6,7,9
```

Output Jul 11 2013

—Kousik Maiti, kousikster@gmail.com



Executing the last C & C++ program

When we create a file with the extensions *.c* or *.cpp* in a directory that already has many similar files, we can easily execute the last or the latest file by executing one of the following commands at the terminal:

```
$gcc [file_name] -lm //for C
```

...or:

```
g++ [file_name] -lm //for C++
```

—Madhav Dixit, madhav0404dixit@gmail.com



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